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Subject: CP - work update, weeks ending 03/21/2008...and 06/20/2008
Date: Monday, June 23, 2008 2:57:30 PM

[NB: the last draft of a report from me had a date of 03/21; this includes that material after the more current stuff.]

EPHT

Portal development

- think, comment, discuss, research...
 - content, design, and interface components
- generate (Lead) maps for display
 - generate clean data necessary for reports/maps!
- learn/experiment with Cognos Reporting environment
 - how to integrate with EPHT Portal
 - install Maine boundary maps (counties, public health districts) in Cognos for map reports
 - [Note: requires Mike Biddle to convert/install what I create]

Asthma/air surveillance

- 2006...
- Update asthma-ED/ozone case-crossover analyses with data from 2004 and 2005 and
 - participate in Asthma 1-day conference
 - review/comment on Baltimore Workshop Final Report, and Talbot et al. white paper
 - get better acquainted with Case-Crossover Analysis Tool

Water

- ~~draft proposal to assist PUC in creating GIS layer of CWS service area boundaries~~
- CWG:
 - o run updated NCDM code as necessary, and to evaluate data displays
- draft/procure Data Sharing Agreement with DWP
 - o discuss with Roger, Robin
- arsenic in private wells mapping project
 - o ~~provide summary of efforts for interim report~~
 - o convert to student project?

Lead

- ~~making maps of '05-'06 data~~
- ~~assist with indicator piloting~~
- assist with address cleaning/resolution of all Lead addresses
- assist with data requests – e.g., census unit tallies for Lewiston-Auburn
- conduct geocoding for all screenees, and '03-'04, '07 EBLs
 - ascertain rental status for all screenees, '05-'06
 - o **say what?** How about just the EBLs statewide – and this should be a “for

later” task

Cancer

- ~~train MCR staff to manipulate, geocode, and resolve data for geocoding~~
 - o ~~install and orient to ZP4 address standardization tool~~
- develop address cleaning and geocoding protocol
- North Deering Project – geocoding, census unit assignment, report assistance
- see below for more MCR-related work

Birth outcomes

- multi-state collaborative
- geocoding

Enterprise Geocoding Service

- procure data/software
- edit DOU, project tasks

Metadata

- ~~continuing input on metadata portal tool, content development~~

Program/MeCDC

Arsenic Exposure Study

- ~~give talk at USM seminar~~
- assist Erin with access to files, old email, etc.
- check out BMDS software
- do more analysis

Cancer Registry

- ~~data summaries for MHHGH Cancer GIS~~
 - o lung ca counts by town or region [**DONE**]
- North Deering Project – geocoding, census unit assignment, report assistance

IPHis / Data Access workgroup(s)

- attend Data Access sub-group meetings

IT planning

- procure a Wiki for testing as project/program management tool

USM

- web site bio
 - faculty meetings
- whatever comes up: teaching?

Narrative

Portal and related things: I've had my head deeply wrapped in Portal-related issues - like most everyone else. I have spent a lot of time learning and futzing with Cognos, to explore the gradations with which we could integrate it (or not) with our custom Portal. My first assessment ("not") was off the mark, and I committed an error of process: I should have phrased the shortcomings I saw in the form of questions to Mike Biddle and/or Cognos Support. There are indeed workable ways of loosely integrating Cognos Reports; however, I still have security concerns, and doubts about whether there will be an installation accessible from outside our firewall in the next couple months. My sense is still that Cognos is not a great product, and not the best for ME-CDC users, but we should certainly milk it for all it's worth.

I have spent untold hours researching "client-side" tools for displaying tables and maps. The benefit of these sorts of solutions is that they don't involve programming (per se), engage the user in interactivity, and have applications outside the Portal (e.g., sharing GIS data with staff and collaborators). However, it's pretty clear that our Portal will not allow much leeway in terms of customizing content, at least at this stage: we will have a relatively few pages hard-coded into the JSP programming, and otherwise our control over content will be limited to what we can do in PDFs that are hosted in the Repository. At one point I had the impression that we could put whatever and however much web content we wanted to below the header/banner. That's not the picture I have now.

I hope our Portal can evolve toward this conception of a content management system (CMS): "A [Web content management system](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Content_management_system) is a CMS designed to simplify the publication of [Web content](#) to Web sites, in particular allowing content creators to submit content without requiring technical knowledge of [HTML](#) or the [uploading](#) of files." http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Content_management_system

At present, I would say that the Portal design, from the authorship perspective, is more like a *file* management system: it manages the access and presentation of (PDF) files. But it complicates the presentation of web content (admittedly, this is partly a consequence of delivering content customized to particular users/roles).

Cognos: I spent two days' training, and numerous hours experimenting with Cognos. I met with Mike Biddle, Rene, and Lisa. There are clearly some issues for which I can be an alternative resource to Lisa, rather than Mike B. I learned how to generate map files to be transferred into Cognos, and gave Mike B. a county map file to use as a trial. However, this is something that requires Mike's system-level access to implement, and I have not had a response from him following through. If we want to integrate maps with Cognos Reports, this is the best way to go. If we're happier keeping maps separate, then it's not a high priority.

Lead data for the Portal: numerous meetings on the array of tabular and chart content we want to present. We have touched on the types of maps we want to present, as well, which will be closely related variations of maps already created and presented to the Lead Advisory groups. However, if we really want strong data-driven decision making, *we need to clean up 5 years worth of data (2 down, 3 to go)*. What needs to be done? Complete the general address clean-up process, geocode them, and go through the task of assessing "exposure address" for the EBLs. This is a couple weeks for me, and would involve several days of part-time interaction/work with Tina and Lisa.

Lead data (other): I'm working on census unit tallies for a Lewiston-Auburn request (akin to Portland/Cumberland Co.). This will be so much easier (and better) when we can share actual addresses with them! They'll be able to choose the census units that fit their aims and (hopefully) make sense of the point clustering.

We should be thinking about the "terms" and technologies under which we transfer address data to them. I can imagine some people will want GIS files of the EBL addresses - and maybe that's fine, as long as we remove year-specific age and personal identifiers. But what if they want to re-release or present the data? Should the terms be: it must follow ME-CDC privacy policy, and have prior approval from ME-CDC? What are the FOIA boundaries here, given the new statute?

Asthma/Air analysis and related goings-on: the Asthma Event (already reported on). Tom Matte and Aaron Cohen sent out a draft report from the Baltimore Workshop, which I'll need to review by the end of the month.

On the docket: to share/discuss BRFSS results with DEP and others. I believe AI noted somebody from WI presenting data on this topic at CSTE.

Also: Ruth L-S will want me to participate in an Asthma workgroup which started brainstorming at the Event.

Water – Data Sharing Agreement, and NCDMs. The draft TPA was fine with Roger, and he's ready to sign the dotted line. I told him I'd have you look at the draft before having him sign. I added Lead Exceedances to the data request, for posterity (this is not part of the initial NCDM data submission). CWG: There have been some updates to the NCDM code, mostly related to graphic display output. At some point, I need to update our SAS code, and review the display output for material that could be used on the Portal.

Cancer Registry: I qc'd the MCR staff's efforts at geocoding Portland area Registry addresses, then assigned census tract IDs to the Cases. This is for the sake of a North Deering (Portland) inquiry, that Castine could not finish before she left, and which Kathy is now working to complete (after hours). This census tract-level analysis is precisely the kind of investigation that will be much more efficient when their data is completely geocoded; even more so if it was integrated with a tool like RIF. The more generic task I've been assigned is to develop a geocoding protocol for them. There is a draft protocol, but finishing that document will be tied to a) my hands-on work with Lead addresses, and b) what comes out of the Enterprise Geocoding Service.

Enterprise Geocoding Service: a nearly signed DOU. I expect I'll need to solicit weekly (if not bi-weekly) progress updates from ADAM. I expect the first iteration to be a hardly-changed update of the prototype they showed earlier. However, if they can deftly handle all the features I put in the DOU, the service will be useful and should garner support for further development. Another item of progress is that we've purchased a license for NAVTEQ data. This means I don't have to resort to mickey-mouse techniques for geocoding in towns where E911 data has not been released. Plus, it gives a good cross-check everywhere else.

Water Service Area boundaries (PUC data): preliminary meeting, project specs, etc. – for work to begin next fiscal year.

Arsenic Exposure Study: I transferred Erin's old email to a Google account, so she can access it from wherever (with state of the art search!). No other developments.

Data Access Workgroup: actively participated in one meeting. Looks like there will be a demo next Wednesday, which I probably won't be able to attend.

USM: Doug wants to hand off the Intro Epi course next spring. Thankfully, Katie is enthusiastic about this opportunity to teach, while I remain enthusiastically ambivalent. However, I'd like to do my share (as long as that isn't too much). Will that be a couple lectures? A partial class every other week? I'll have to discuss with Katie.

Misc: Lead Candidate talks and meetings; arsenic test geocoding; minor consultations and epi paper readings.

[from 03/21/2008]